Front End Design

Above: The architecture §4.1 and the front door.

Talks to: the desk home described by DESK.md and the forthcoming home specification, currently listed as “to write” in the design tree; the Journal and its review requirements; and the front-door routes and shared login.

Reference: approved Trade-Disk Trading Station homepage concept, supplied by the trader on 2026-10-13. The written decisions below resolve ambiguous or conflicting labels in the reference.

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1. Purpose and boundary

This document specifies the **Trade-Disk Trading Station home / front-end entry screen**: the first screen a signed-in trader reaches, the four product cards, and the route from that home into the Journal.

It is **not the Journal design**. Journal pages, data, capture, metrics, navigation and responsive behavior remain defined by JOURNAL.md, REVIEW.md and IMPORT.md. This document adds the product-level front door that precedes those pages.

The front door remains a thin entry point. It does not own trading records, calculate performance, place orders, authenticate users independently, or make the other tools operational. The front-door component’s technical ownership and login/routing rules remain in FRONT-DOOR.md; the desk owns home behavior and cross-tool content as detailed in the desk design.

Route ownership

- `/` is the Trading Station / desk home after the shared login.
- `/login` is the shared sign-in route from FRONT-DOOR.md.
- `/journal/` enters the independent Journal product. Its initial screen is the Journal overview/landing page, not a second Trade-Disk home.
- Returning from the Journal to `/` returns to the Trading Station home.
- The Journal remains usable as an independently accessible product, subject to its own account and access design.

Implementation boundary: the existing static prototype is stored at `journal/index.html`, but that directory is not the production route definition. When integrated into the desk, the Trading Station home belongs at `/` and the Journal belongs at `/journal/`. Do not deploy the

same home page as the Journal overview or place the home route inside the Journal's product navigation.

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2. Product inventory and launch state

The home presents four distinct Trade-Disk tools:

Order	Tool	Home-card purpose	Status for this design	Action
1	**Trading Journal**	Track real trades, review performance, and improve process	**Available first**	Open `/journal/`
2	**Radar**	Find and screen stock opportunities	**In development / Coming soon**	Informational card only; no unavailable tool route
3	**TradeLab**	Charting, indicators, strategy development and backtesting	**In development / Coming soon**	Informational card only; no unavailable tool route
4	**TradePilot**	Algorithmic strategy automation and execution controls	**In development / Coming soon**	Informational card only; no unavailable tool route

The trader's explicit status decision is authoritative: **the Journal is the one available tool; the other three are being built.** The supplied image contains inconsistent badges that show Radar and TradeLab as available in one treatment. Do not copy those badges. Display all three non-Journal tools as **Coming soon** (or the consistent equivalent **In development**) and keep them non-navigable until their own designs and routes are approved.

Do not make a disabled card look clickable, invent a release date, simulate an available product, or imply that an unfinished tool can be launched. When product status changes, update this table and the desk tool registry/route contract together.

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3. Page composition and hierarchy

The desktop layout follows the supplied light/dark concept. The hierarchy is the same in either theme.

3.1 Header

- Trade-Disk mark and wordmark at the left; descriptor: **THE TRADING STATION**.
- Product navigation and account actions at the right.
- **Products** scrolls to the four-tool section.
- **Sign in** uses the shared `/login` route when signed out; the signed-in state uses the shared account/sign-out behavior, not a second authentication system.
- **Get Started** is a prominent route to the only currently available product, the Journal at `/journal/`.
- **Pricing**, **Resources**, **About**, and search appear only when their destinations and behavior are defined. They must not be dead links, empty overlays, or fabricated product promises. The desk home specification (`HOME.md`) owns any cross-tool navigation or content not defined here.

3.2 Hero

- Eyebrow: **ANALYZE. PLAN. EXECUTE. IMPROVE.**
- Headline: **Your Trading. One Station.** with the second line/accent visually emphasized.
- Supporting message: four tools help the trader find opportunities, analyze, test, trade and improve, on web and Android.
- Primary action: **Open Trading Journal** (or the consistent short label **Open Journal**) routes to `/journal/`.
- Secondary action: **Explore the tools** scrolls to the product cards.
- Three short proof points: web and Android; tools usable independently; built for active traders. Do not claim platform support that has not been implemented.
- A product-workspace visual may show a desktop screen with a companion mobile view. Prefer real UI from this application. If it shows sample figures or sample trades, label them as illustrative/demo; never imply that synthetic figures are the trader’s real performance.

3.3 Four-tool section

- Section heading: **Four Tools. One Complete Trading Station.** (or the equivalent approved headline **Choose your trading tool**).
- Supporting line clarifies that tools can be used independently and that only the Journal is available first.
- Four cards in the table order above. Each includes its tool name, one-sentence purpose, distinct icon/color treatment, and a visible status label.
- The Journal card is first and visually prioritized (blue primary accent, clear launch action); it links to `/journal/`.
- Radar, TradeLab, and TradePilot are visually present as future tools, but subdued and non-interactive. Their status labels are explicit and consistent.

3.4 Journal callout and footer

- A secondary Journal callout may follow the tool grid, reinforcing **Available now** and linking to `/journal/`.
- The footer identifies Trade-Disk and may contain links only to destinations defined by their owning design documents.
- A concise demo/data notice is required anywhere sample market figures or trade outcomes are shown.

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4. Visual system

- **Brand character:** focused, trustworthy, modern trading software; clear data hierarchy, not a noisy broker terminal.
- **Color:** saturated blue is the primary Trade-Disk action/accent, balanced with near-white surfaces in light mode and deep navy surfaces in dark mode. The two themes preserve contrast and meaning. Do not reuse the Journal's green accent as the global Trade-Disk brand accent; Journal may retain its own product accent within its own workspace.
- **Typography:** a clean sans-serif family; bold compact hero headline, restrained navigation, readable card titles and body copy. Avoid condensed all-caps body text.
- **Layout:** wide responsive hero with copy and a product visual side by side on desktop; vertically stacked on phones. Four cards form a balanced row on wide screens and a two-column or single-column stack on narrow screens.

- **Cards:** consistent geometry and spacing; the Journal uses the strongest visual emphasis. Future-tool status is visible without making the entire card resemble an active button.
- **Illustration:** use actual UI screenshots or a clearly labelled interface illustration. Do not present illustrative chart values as live quotes, verified analysis, or account data.
- **Motion:** short, low-amplitude hover/focus transitions only. Respect reduced-motion preferences; do not animate charts as though they are live.

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5. Interaction, accessibility and responsive behavior

Interactions

- All Journal CTAs and the Journal card resolve to the same `/journal/` destination.
- Products navigation and the secondary hero action scroll to the four-tool section and preserve keyboard access.
- Unavailable tools are not anchors or buttons. They expose their “Coming soon” status as readable text; no fake click response.
- Sign in follows the shared login from FRONT-DOOR.md. No public registration or subscription workflow is implied by this home-page design.
- Home navigation remains available from Journal pages using the front-door link and route.

Accessibility

- Use semantic header, navigation, main, section and footer landmarks with a meaningful heading order.
- Provide visible keyboard focus, descriptive link/button labels, and accessible names for icon-only controls.
- Do not communicate availability by color alone; every tool card has text status.
- Maintain WCAG AA text contrast for both themes. Support 200% zoom and reduced motion.

Responsive requirements

Use the Journal responsive acceptance widths as shared viewport targets: **360, 390, 640, 1024 and 1440 CSS px**. At every width:

- the home fills the available viewport without page-level horizontal scrolling;

- header actions remain reachable (collapse low-priority text navigation before shrinking the Journal CTA);
- the hero text and visual reflow without overlap or clipped labels;
- product cards remain in reading order: Journal, Radar, TradeLab, TradePilot;
- non-available status labels remain visible;
- touch targets are comfortably usable on Android; and
- the Journal action remains obvious without requiring hover.

The Journal's own detailed responsive contract remains in REVIEW.md §10.

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6. Copy and product-truth rules

- The home describes **four tools**, but clearly distinguishes **one available now** from **three in development**.
- The first screen's next action is to open the Journal; there is no promise that all four tools are ready.
- Use "trading journal" for recording and analyzing actual trades. Do not imply that the Journal places orders.
- Never display fabricated prices, personal results, integrations, subscriptions, testimonials, or release dates as facts.
- If sample performance data is used inside a UI illustration, mark it as synthetic demo data, consistent with IMPLEMENTATION-STATUS.md.
- Keep Trading Station home copy and functionality separate from Journal-specific metrics and feature claims.

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7. Contracts and ownership

Concern	Owner / contract
`/` and `/journal/` routing, shared login, URL prefixes	FRONT-DOOR.md
Home content, tool availability, cross-tool lists, Manage tools	DESK.md; detailed home behavior belongs in the planned `03-desk/HOME.md` (listed as “to write” in the design tree)
Tool identifiers, configured/running/stopped status and route registry	DESK.md and FILES.md
Journal overview, records, metrics, responsive workspace and product boundaries	JOURNAL.md and REVIEW.md
Trade capture/import	IMPORT.md
TradeLab capabilities	QP.md
Shared navigation across programs	FRONT-DOOR.md §3.4

This front-end document does not define new backend APIs, tool registry fields, release dates, account plans, or Journal calculations. Those belong to their respective design documents.

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8. Completion criteria

The front-end design is complete when an implementation:

1. Opens the signed-in trader at the Trade-Disk home `/`, not at a Journal-only overview.
2. Shows the four tools in the specified order and clearly marks the Journal as the first available tool.
3. Marks Radar, TradeLab and TradePilot as in development/coming soon and provides no false launch action for them.
4. Routes the Journal card and primary CTA to `/journal/`; the Journal remains its own product and overview.
5. Preserves the shared login and route behavior in FRONT-DOOR.md.

6. Matches the approved light/dark visual direction, blue Trade-Disk accent, hierarchy and responsive composition.
7. Works at the required viewport widths, with no page-level horizontal overflow and with keyboard/touch access to the Journal.
8. Labels illustrative sample information honestly and does not claim unbuilt features.
9. Leaves detailed home operations to the desk's `HOME.md` and leaves Journal behavior to its existing design documents; any newly discovered requirement is added to its owning document rather than duplicated here.

Dependencies and status

The **visual/front-door scope in this document is specified**. Before treating the whole home experience as production-complete, reconcile implementation with the desk's planned `HOME.md` (cross-tool lists and Manage tools), `WEB.md` (page/request behavior), and the tool registry in `FILES.md`; both planned documents are listed as "to write" in the design tree. A missing detail in those documents is a documented dependency, not permission to invent behavior. This file does not change the build status of Radar, TradeLab or TradePilot, nor claim the front-end is deployed as the permanent production home.